

Nokia's Android Strategy is to go Google-less

Finally, Nokia has got on to the Android bandwagon. The Finnish handset maker has launched not one, but three Android smartphones. Interestingly, this move from the company is supposed to benefit Microsoft more than Android. **Prasid Banerjee** from *Open Source For You* spoke to **Pranav Shroff**, product marketing manager, Nokia, about the firm's Android strategy.



Pranav Shroff, product marketing manager, Nokia

So, the first Android smartphone from Nokia is now officially out, but we wish we could say that the Finnish company is pulling out all the stops. But then, with Microsoft acquiring Nokia, this isn't a very big surprise. Nokia's first Android device is essentially a Google-less version of Android. The company is running it on its own Nokia X platform, which is based on the Android Open Source Project (AOSP), version 4.1.2.

While it is based on AOSP, Nokia X isn't in itself an open source platform. Nokia has replaced things like Google Maps, Google Play and Google Drive with its own Here Maps, Nokia Store and Microsoft OneDrive. In addition, the user interface in this device looks almost

exactly like the Windows Phone platform, which once again screams of intervention by Microsoft.

Here's what developers will get

On the apps front, Nokia claims that the new platform can run about 75 per cent of the apps that run on Android. The company has come up with quite a few tools and the services SDK in order to attract developers to the Nokia X platform. According to Pranav Shroff, product marketing manager, Nokia, it takes about eight hours to port an app to the platform. The company has also introduced the App Compatibility Analyzer in order to aid developers. Shroff says, "This tool lets you put your app's .apk file into the system, which then analyses whether your app is compatible with the platform. If not, it tells you whether modifications are required. The tool points down to the exact line of code(s) that needs to be modified in order to make the app run on the platform." The tool is available on Nokia's developers' site (<http://developer.nokia.com/nokia-x/platform-overview>). According to the website, your app will need porting if it includes in-app payments, Google services for push notifications or maps.

Besides, in order to help developers promote their apps, Nokia is offering the DVLUP programme, which is a rewards program for developers. Using this, developers can create app promotion campaigns against the experience points they have earned while developing the apps. The campaigns available range from promotion in the Nokia store to social media, retail newsletters and in-app advertising. The promotions are available both globally and locally. In addition to the DVLUP programme, Nokia is also offering some free tools to developers, which will aid them in app development for the platform.

The real strategy

The company is going to launch its other two Android devices, X+ and XL, within a couple of months, completing its current portfolio in the Android segment. The Finnish smartphone maker, that used to lead the Indian market in sales at one time, has also confirmed